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Systems and methods for customer-personalized videos

Abstract

A method of creating custom video sequences includes presenting an ecommerce website to a customer and automatically collecting electronic customer data from the ecommerce website by a server system. The electronic customer data describes at least one customer interaction with the ecommerce website is automatically collected concurrently with customer interaction(s). The method further includes, concurrently with automatically collecting the electronic customer data, creating a customer profile of a customer based on the electronic customer data, determining a set of offering descriptors based on at least one customer descriptor, automatically selecting a subset of video segments from a plurality of video segments based on the set of offering descriptors, and automatically sequencing the subset of video segments into a custom video. The method further includes automatically modifying a web page of the ecommerce website by inserting the custom video into the web page.

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Background/Summary

BACKGROUND

(1) The present disclosure relates to ecommerce and, more particularly, systems and electronic methods for automatically modifying ecommerce websites to include personalized content.

(2) Ecommerce websites can include a large variety of offerings, such as products and/or services. Where an ecommerce website includes a large number of offerings, it can be difficult for customers browsing the ecommerce website to find products and/or services that are relevant to them, which can result in a decreased volume of sales on the ecommerce website. The creation of personalized, relevant offerings and promotional content for a customer browsing the ecommerce website can require significant computational resources. Further, the process of manually sorting and categorizing a large inventory of offerings can be significantly labor-intensive.

SUMMARY

(3) According to one aspect of the present disclosure, a method of creating custom video sequences includes presenting an ecommerce website to a customer and automatically collecting electronic customer data from the ecommerce website by a server system. The electronic customer data describes at least one customer interaction with the ecommerce website and is automatically collected concurrently with the customer interaction(s). The method further includes, concurrently with automatically collecting the electronic customer data, the steps of creating a customer profile of a customer based on the electronic customer data, determining a set of offering descriptors based on at least one customer descriptor, automatically selecting a subset of video segments from a plurality of video segments based on the set of offering descriptors, and automatically sequencing the subset of video segments into a custom video. The customer profile includes the customer descriptor(s). The method further includes automatically modifying a web page of the ecommerce website by inserting the custom video into the web page.

(4) According to a further aspect of the present disclosure, a system for creating custom video sequences includes a web server, an ecommerce website hosted by the webserver, and an application server in electronic communication with the webserver. The application server comprises a processor and memory. The memory is encoded with instructions that, when executed, cause the processor to automatically collect electronic customer data from the ecommerce website. The electronic customer data describes at least one customer interaction with the ecommerce website and is automatically collected concurrently with the at least one customer interaction. The instructions, when executed, further cause the processor to, concurrently with the automatic collection of the electronic customer data, create a customer profile of the customer based on the electronic customer data, determine a set of offering descriptors based on at least one customer descriptor, automatically select a subset of video segments of a plurality of video segments based on the set of offering descriptors, and automatically sequence the subset of video segments into a custom video. The customer profile comprises the at least one customer descriptor. The instructions, when executed, further cause the processor to automatically modify a web page of the ecommerce website by inserting the custom video into the web page.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 is a schematic diagram of an example of a web computer system for generating custom offering information.

(2) FIG. 2 is a schematic diagram of an example of a descriptor taxonomy suitable for use with the web computer system of FIG. 1.

(3) FIG. 3 is a flow diagram of an example of a method of generating a descriptor taxonomy suitable for use with the web computer system of FIG. 1 and the descriptor taxonomy of FIG. 2.

(4) FIG. 4 is a flow diagram of an example of a method of creating a customer profile using a

descriptor taxonomy suitable for use with the web computer system of FIG. 1.

(5) FIG. 5 is a flow diagram of an example of a method of creating customer descriptors suitable for use with the method of FIG. 4.

(6) FIG. 6 is a flow diagram of an example of a method of generating relevant offerings suitable for use with the web computer system of FIG. 1.

(7) FIG. 7 is a flow diagram of an example of a method of identifying nodes of a descriptor taxonomy based on a customer profile suitable for use with the methods of FIG. 6 and FIG. 8.

(8) FIG. 8 is a flow diagram of an example of a method of creating a custom video based on a customer profile suitable for use with the web computer system of FIG. 1.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(9) The present disclosure relates to systems and method for determining customer preferences according to a descriptor taxonomy. As will be described in more detail subsequently, the systems and methods disclosed herein can be used to create a digital profile of a customer browsing an ecommerce website automatically and concurrently with the browsing activity. The systems and methods disclosed herein can also be used to create a set of descriptors describing products and/or services that the customer may be interested in purchasing automatically and concurrently with the browsing activity. The set of descriptors can be used to, for example, create custom product and/or service recommendations. The set of descriptors can also be used to create a custom video promoting products and/or services for sale on the ecommerce website from a pre-recorded library of video segments. The custom product and/or service recommendations and the custom video can be delivered to the customer in real-time or in substantially real-time, such that the promotional content and/or offering recommendations the customer receives can be updated in real-time or in substantially real-time as the customer continues to browse the ecommerce website.

(10) The descriptor taxonomies disclosed herein provide an organizational method for relating services and/or products offered for sale on an ecommerce website according to the attributes of those services and/or products described by the descriptors. The descriptor taxonomies described herein reduce the computational load required to create custom product and/or service recommendations from a large inventory of products and/or services. Further, the descriptor taxonomies described herein reduce the computational load required to create custom promotional videos describing products and/or services that a customer is likely interested in purchasing.

(11) By using a descriptor taxonomy, the systems and methods disclosed herein allow for rapid creation of personalized web page content for each customer visiting and browsing an ecommerce website. The personalized web page content can be created concurrently with the customer's browsing of the ecommerce website. Existing methods that do not use a descriptor taxonomy are less effective at predicting products and/or services that a customer may be interested in purchasing and require significantly more computational load to create personalized web page content.

(12) Further, the use of a descriptor taxonomy can significantly reduce the overall labor, including both computational load and human labor, required to identify related products and/or services in a large inventory of products and/or services. As will be explained in more detail subsequently, the organizational structure of the taxonomy can be used to relate products, reducing or eliminating the need to manually associate related products.

(13) FIG. 1 is a schematic diagram of server system **10**, which is a system for generating custom offering information. Server system **10** includes application server **100**, web server **102**, and database server **104**. In the illustrated embodiment, web server **102** is communicatively connected to user devices **106A-N** via network **110**. Application server **100** includes processor **112**, memory **114**, and user interface **116**. Memory **114** contains customer profile module **130**, offering recommendation module **140**, and custom video module **150**. Memory **114** also contains descriptor taxonomy **152** and profiling criteria **154**, which are depicted adjacent to dotted lines **156A** and **156B** in FIG. 1. Web server **102** includes ecommerce website **162**, which includes custom offering recommendations **164**, custom video **166**, and preference questionnaire **168**. Database server **104**

includes database **172**. User devices **106A-N** are operated by customers **186A-N**.

(14) Application server **100** includes processor **112**, memory **114**, and user interface **116**, and is configured to run one or more programs for performing one or more methods described herein. Processor **112** of application server **100** is configured to run programs, applications, and/or executable software stored on memory **114**. Application server **100** is connected to web server **102** and database server **104**, such that processor **112** is able to request data from and/or cause data to be transmitted to web server **102** and/or database server **104**. Processor **112** can include one or more of a microprocessor, a controller, a digital signal processor (DSP), an application specific integrated circuit (ASIC), a field-programmable gate array (FPGA), or other equivalent discrete or integrated logic circuitry. Processor **112** can be entirely or partially mounted on one or more boards. Processor **112** can be of any type suitable for operating in accordance with the techniques described herein. In some examples, process or **112** can be implemented as a plurality of discrete circuitry subassemblies.

(15) Memory **114**, sometimes referred to as computer-readable storage media, is a machine-readable data storage medium or collection of media configured to store information. In some examples, a computer-readable storage medium can include a non-transitory medium. The term “non-transitory” can indicate that the storage medium is not embodied in a carrier wave or a propagated signal. In certain examples, a non-transitory storage medium can store data that can, over time, change (e.g., in RAM or cache). In some examples, memory **114** is a temporary memory. As used herein, a temporary memory refers to a memory having a primary purpose that is not long-term storage. Memory **114**, in some examples, is described as volatile memory. As used herein, a volatile memory refers to a memory that the memory does not maintain stored contents when power to the memory **114** is turned off. Examples of volatile memories can include random access memories (RAM), dynamic random access memories (DRAM), static random access memories (SRAM), and other forms of volatile memories. In some examples, memory **114** is used to store program instructions for execution by processor **112**. Memory **114**, in one example, is used by software or applications running on application server **100** (e.g., by a computer-implemented machine learning model or a data processing module) to temporarily store information during program execution.

(16) Memory **114**, in some examples, also includes one or more computer-readable storage media. Memory **114** can be configured to store larger amounts of information than volatile memory. Memory **114** can further be configured for long-term storage of information. For example, memory **114** can be configured to store application data and/or database data. In some examples, memory **114** includes non-volatile storage elements. Examples of such non-volatile storage elements can include, for example, magnetic hard discs, optical discs, floppy discs, flash memories, or forms of electrically programmable memories (EPROM) or electrically erasable and programmable (EEPROM) memories.

(17) User interface **116** is an input and/or output device and enables an operator to control operation of application server **100**. For example, user interface **116** can be configured to receive inputs from an operator and/or provide outputs regarding predicted individual mental state. User interface **116** can include one or more of a sound card, a video graphics card, a speaker, a display device (such as a liquid crystal display (LCD), a light emitting diode (LED) display, an organic light emitting diode (OLED) display, etc.), a touchscreen, a keyboard, a mouse, a joystick, or other type of device for facilitating input and/or output of information in a form understandable to users and/or machines.

(18) Web server **102** is a web host connected to network **110** that hosts ecommerce website **162**. Web server **102** is capable of transmitting information to and requesting information from application server **100** and/or database server **104**. In some examples, web server **102** is a hardware server and includes a processor, memory, and/or a user interface. The processor, memory, and/or user interface can be substantially the same as processor **112**, memory **114**, and user interface **116**

described previously. Additionally and/or alternatively, web server **102** can be a virtual server implemented on a separate hardware device. For example, web server **102** can be implemented on the hardware of application server **100**. Webserver **102** is accessible to user devices **106A-N** via network **110**. When a customer **186A-N** operates user devices **106A-N** to connect to web server **102**, web server **102** can present one or more web pages of ecommerce website to the customer **186A-N** by transmitting data from ecommerce website **162** to the customer's user device **106A-N**. (19) Database server **104** is a database server for storage data in one or more databases. In FIG. **1**, database server **104** is depicted as including database **172**, which is a database for organizing and storing offering information. Programs running on application server **100** and/or web server **102** can access and/or query information stored on database **172**. In some examples, database server **104** is a hardware server and includes a processor, memory, and/or a user interface. The processor, memory, and/or user interface can be substantially the same as processor **112**, memory **114**, and user interface **116** described previously. Additionally and/or alternatively, database server **104** can be a virtual server implemented on a separate hardware device. For example, database server **104** can be implemented on the hardware of application server **100**. In some examples, both web server **102** and database server **104** are implemented on the hardware of application server **100**.

(20) Database server **104** includes machine-readable data storage capable of retrievably housing stored data, such as database or application data. The machine-readable data storage can be non-volatile memory or another non-volatile storage media. For example, non-volatile storage media can include magnetic hard discs, optical discs, flash memories and other forms of solid-state memory, and/or forms of electrically programmable memories (EPROM) or electrically erasable and programmable (EEPROM) memories.

(21) User devices **106A-N** are computing devices connected to network **110** and can include a processor, memory, and/or a user interface. The processor, memory, and/or user interface can be substantially the same as processor **112**, memory **114**, and user interface **116** described previously. User devices **106A-N** can also be virtual devices implemented on another hardware device. User devices **106A-N** are capable of receiving inputs from customers **186A-N** and transmitting those inputs to web server **102** via network **110** in order to enable customers **186A-N** to browse ecommerce website **162**.

(22) Network **110** is an electronic communication network for communicatively coupling user devices **106A-N** to webserver **102**. Network **110** allows customers **186A-N** to access ecommerce website **162** via user devices **106A-N**. Network **110** can be, for example, the internet or another suitable multi-device network.

(23) Ecommerce website **162** is a website for performing one or more ecommerce transactions. Ecommerce website **162** includes one or more web pages and is configured to transmit data to user devices **106A-N** based on one or more requests made by user devices **106A-N**. Customers **186A-N** can use user devices **106A-N** to browse ecommerce website **162** and purchase one or more products and/or services offered for sale on ecommerce website **162**. As used herein, a “offering” refers to one or more products and/or services offered for sale. The total group of offerings offered for sale on ecommerce website **162** is referred to herein as an “inventory” of offerings. The web pages of ecommerce website **162** are configured to allow a customer **186A-N** to, for example, make purchases, obtain offering recommendations, and/or request information that describes offerings available for purchase on ecommerce website **162**, among other options.

(24) Offering descriptors describing aspects of the offerings of the inventory of offerings can be created and organized into descriptor taxonomy **152**, described subsequently. The offering descriptors are selected to describe various aspects of the offerings or categories to which the offerings belong, such that all offerings offered for sale can be adequately described by a combination of offering descriptors. Generally, the number of available offering descriptors is smaller than the overall number of available offerings. For example, 200 offerings may be adequately described by five categories of offering descriptors. Each category may include, for

example, between two and four offering descriptors, such that between 10 and 20 offering descriptors are able to describe all 200 offerings. The above example is provided for explanatory purposes, and in other examples the total number of offerings may be adequately described by another number of categories and/or offering descriptors.

(25) Database **172** is an electronic database and is stored on storage of database server **104**.

Database **172** organizes related data such that a processor (e.g., processor **112**) can query database **172** to retrieve values stored in database **172**. For example, database **172** can organize related offering descriptors and offerings, such that querying database **172** with one or more offering descriptors retrieves offerings related to the queried offering descriptors.

(26) Data stored in database **172** is organized according to a database management system. As used herein, a “database management system” refers to a system of organizing and/or managing data stored on a data storage medium. In some examples, a database management system described herein is configured to run operations on data stored on the data storage medium. The operations can be requested by a user and/or by another application, program, and/or software. The data stored on the machine-readable data storage of database server **104** can be structured or unstructured as required by the database management system used to manage the data.

(27) Customer profile module **130** includes one or more programs stored to memory **114** for generating a customer profile. A customer profile is a digital profile that describes offerings that a customer may be interested in based on one or more attributes of the customer. The customer can be, for example, one of customers **186A-N** (e.g., a user shopping on their own behalf). In other examples, customers **186A-N** are buyers interacting with ecommerce website **162** to shop on behalf of a purchasing entity (e.g., a buyer shopping on behalf of a large entity). Customer profile module **130** can execute one or more programs to, for example, analyze activity of customers **186A-N** interacting with ecommerce website **162** to determine customer attributes. Additionally and/or alternatively, customer profile module **130** can create a questionnaire of one or more questions that can be answered by one or more of customers **186A-N** to determine customer attributes.

Ecommerce website **162** can pose questions of the questionnaire to customers **186A-N** interacting with ecommerce website **162**. Customer profile module **130** can use, for example, customer profiling criteria **154**, explained in more detail subsequently, to determine which attributes should be included in a customer profile.

(28) Customer profile module **130** can automatically collect electronic customer data of customer activity on ecommerce website **162**. The electronic customer data can describe, for example, a customer's browsing history on ecommerce website **162**. The electronic customer data can also describe, for example, a customer's answers to a questionnaire hosted on ecommerce website **162**. The questionnaire can be designed to determine customer preferences. The electronic customer data can include first-order data reflective of a customer's activity on ecommerce website **162** and/or metadata of the first-order data. Processor **112** can generate metadata from data stored to memory **114** and store the metadata **114** for use with the creation of a customer profile. First-order data may describe, for example, the contents of a webpage visited by the customer, while metadata may describe, for example, the frequency with which a customer visits a given webpage of ecommerce website **162**.

(29) The electronic customer data collected by customer profile module **130** can be used to create one or more customer descriptors that describe and categorize a customer's interests and/or preferences. Customer profile module **130** can select the one or more customer descriptors from a pre-determined pool of customer descriptors based on the collected electronic customer data and can store those customer descriptors to a customer profile.

(30) Offering recommendation module **140** includes one or more programs for creating a custom set of offerings. The custom set of offerings are recommendations of offerings sold on ecommerce website **162** that a customer is likely to be interested in based on their customer profile. Offering recommendation module **140** can generate a custom set of recommended offerings based on the

customer profile generated by customer profile module **130**. In some examples, offering recommendation module **140** can use a descriptor taxonomy, such as descriptor taxonomy **152**, to generate a custom set of offerings for a customer. In some examples, offering recommendation module **140** uses the customer profile and descriptor taxonomy **152** to determine offering descriptors pertaining to offerings the customer may be interested in. Offering recommendation module **140** can then query database **172** of database server **104** to determine what offerings correspond to those offering descriptors and provide those offerings to website modification module **160**. As will be described subsequently, website modification module **160** can modify a web page of ecommerce website **162** that the customer is browsing to cause the web page to display the custom set of offerings.

(31) Custom video module **150** includes one or more programs for creating a custom video for a customer. The custom video can include one or more video sequences that relate to offerings that the customer may be interested in. Custom video module **150** can use the customer profile created by customer profile module **130** and/or offering descriptors created by offering recommendation module **140** to select video sequences that should be included in the custom video. The custom video can then be output to the customer via, for example, ecommerce website **162**. The video sequences of the custom video can alert the customer to and inform the customer about various offerings available for purchase on ecommerce website **162**. The video sequences can be pre-determined and pre-generated video sequences describing and/or targeting offerings having one or more common offering descriptors. The video sequences can include one or more of a testimonial, a demonstration, an offering description, or a case study involving the offering, among other options.

(32) Website modification module **160** includes one or more programs for modifying web pages and web page content of ecommerce website **162** that is transmitted to user devices **106A-N**. Website modification module **160** can automatically update web page information delivered to user devices **106A-N** based on the custom set of offerings created by offering recommendation module **140** and/or custom video module **150**. Website modification module **160** can, for example, modify a web page of ecommerce website **162** to display the custom offerings generated by offering recommendation module **140** instead of a default set of generic offerings. Website modification module **160** can also modify a web page of ecommerce website **162** by inserting a custom video created by custom video module **150**. Website modification module **160** can insert a custom video by inserting the entire custom video into the webpage, inserting a pointer to the custom video into the web page, and/or by inserting pointers to all video sequences used to create the custom video as well as code that can be used to order the video sequences into the custom video, among other options.

(33) Descriptor taxonomy **152** is stored on memory **114** and organizes offering descriptors in a hierarchical taxonomy having multiple, hierarchical layers of nodes. In the depicted example, descriptor taxonomy **152** includes nodes labeled S.sub.t, A, B, C, D, E, and F. Nodes labeled A-F corresponds to offering descriptors and node S.sub.t corresponds to a starting node for using descriptor taxonomy **152** to determine a custom set of offerings and/or to create a custom video with offering recommendation module **140** and/or custom video module **150**, respectively. Node S.sub.t is in the zero-level layer of descriptor taxonomy **152**, nodes A and B are in the first layer of descriptor taxonomy **152**, and nodes C-F are in the second layer of descriptor taxonomy **152**. Descriptor taxonomies are described in greater detail below with reference to the examples provided in FIG. 2.

(34) Each of the offering descriptors organized by descriptor taxonomy **152** corresponds to one more customer descriptors that can be stored to a customer profile by customer profile module **130**. Descriptor taxonomy **152** can be encoded on memory **114** such that processor **112** can determine offering descriptors that correspond to customer descriptors of the customer in a hierarchical manner. Starting at node S.sub.t, processor **112** can determine whether one of the customer

descriptors of the customer profile corresponds to the offering descriptor of either node A or node B. If one of the customer descriptors corresponds to the offering descriptor of node A, processor **112** can then examine whether there is another customer descriptor that corresponds to one of nodes C or D. Similarly, if one of the customer descriptors corresponds to the offering descriptor of node B, processor **112** can then examine whether there is another customer descriptor that corresponds to one of nodes E or F. If the customer profile does not include a customer descriptor that corresponds to nodes A or B, processor **112** can examine whether one of the customer descriptors corresponds to C, D, E, or F. The process of searching from a zero-level root node (e.g., starting node S.sub.t) to a terminal layer of child nodes (e.g., the layer of nodes C-F) is referred to herein as searching a descriptor taxonomy in a “downward” manner. Processor **112** can query database **172** with all offering descriptors matched to customer descriptors in this manner to create a custom set of offerings. As will be explained in more detail subsequently, processor **112** can also use the offering descriptors of parent and child nodes of matched nodes of descriptor taxonomy **162** to query database **172**.

(35) All child nodes of a common parent node within the same layer of descriptor taxonomy **152** correspond to one category for describing the offerings available on ecommerce website **162**. In examples where a category applies to all goods, it may be appropriate for all nodes of a single layer to correspond to that category. In examples where a category only applies to a subset of goods, it may be appropriate for only certain nodes having a common parent node to correspond to one category for characterizing goods. Referring to descriptor taxonomy **152**, a single category may apply to all of nodes C-F, or nodes C-D and E-F may represent different categories for characterizing goods. As a specific example, depending on the structure of descriptor taxonomy **152** and the types of goods included in the inventory of ecommerce website **162**, all of nodes C-F may describe different sub-groups of offerings within the category of business need. In another example, node A may correspond to hardware offerings while node B corresponds to software offerings. In this example, nodes C-D can describe a hardware product's wireless capabilities while nodes E-F describe a software product's operating system compatibility. The above examples are non-limiting and are provided to illustrate the inventory-specific manner in which a descriptor taxonomy **152** can be organized.

(36) Each node within a given hierarchical layer corresponds to one option within a given organizational category, where each option describes a property of an offering and/or a customer preference, interest, and/or need. Descriptor taxonomy **152** can be constructed by analyzing the offerings offered on ecommerce web site **162** to determine the desired organizational categories and options within each category.

(37) For example, a customer may have preferences regarding technology type, business need, relative experience in a given field and/or with a given technology, and brand based on the needs, interests, and/or preferences of that customer. Descriptor taxonomy can then be constructed to have four hierarchical layers of offering descriptors (i.e., four layers of nodes lower than node S e), corresponding to each category (i.e., one for each of technology type, business need, relative experience, and brand). Using the brand category as a further example, each node within the brand layer of the hierarchical taxonomy can correspond to a different brand option among the offerings available for purchase on ecommerce website **162**. Similarly, using the relative experience category as another example, each node within the relative experience layer of the hierarchical taxonomy can correspond to a different level of customer experience with a given product line and/or in a given technological field. In this manner, descriptor taxonomy can incorporate and organize descriptors relating both to properties of services offerings (e.g., brand) and customer preferences, interests, and/or needs (e.g., relative experience).

(38) Descriptor taxonomy **152** is depicted in FIG. **1** as including only two hierarchical layers of offering descriptors for explanatory purposes and to improve clarity. In other examples, descriptor taxonomy **152** can include more than two hierarchical layers. Further, each parent node of

descriptor taxonomy **152** is depicted in FIG. **1** as including only two child nodes for explanatory purposes and to improve clarity. In other examples, nodes of descriptor taxonomy **152** can have more than two child nodes or fewer than two child nodes, and can also have different numbers of child nodes.

(39) Having different numbers of child nodes for different parent nodes can be useful where, for example, ecommerce website **162** includes offerings that are specialized and/or biased toward a particular customer interest, need, and/or preference. Using technology type and business need as explanatory examples of customer preference, the offerings of ecommerce website **162** may meet a wider variety of business needs for particular technology types, such that a larger number of offering descriptors is required to accurately describe all business needs met by the offerings that belong to those technology types. In this example, descriptor taxonomy **152** can be organized such that technology type can be placed one level of descriptor taxonomy **152** higher than business needs. Technology types having offerings that meet a larger variety of business needs will have a commensurately larger number of child nodes in the business need layer of the hierarchical descriptor taxonomy.

(40) The use of a hierarchical descriptor taxonomy provides numerous advantages over existing methods. Organizing offering descriptors in a hierarchical taxonomy (e.g., descriptor taxonomy **152**) allows for efficient identification of offerings that are relevant to a customer, especially for ecommerce websites offering for sale a large number of offerings. Processor **112** can, in a stepwise fashion, exclude large numbers of offerings based on a customer's customer profile and include only offerings that are likely to be relevant to a customer's needs, interests, and/or preferences. Providing more relevant offerings can increase customer engagement, promote repeat purchases, and increase overall customer satisfaction.

(41) The use of hierarchical descriptor taxonomies also significantly reduces the human labor required to determine which offerings of an inventory of offerings are related. Existing methods that do not use a descriptor taxonomy require manual association of related offering in an offering-by-offering manner in order to provide accurate relationships between offerings. Conversely, a descriptor taxonomy only requires that products be labeled with descriptors, and then that the limited number of descriptors be hierarchically arranged. In this manner, a descriptor taxonomy requires significantly less human labor to create than existing methods of organizing and associating offerings. Reducing human labor required to label and associate related offerings of an inventory can significantly reduce labor costs associated with operating an ecommerce website.

(42) For example, a brand may have products and/or servicing within more than one class of offering, and a customer may be interested in the brand but may only be interested in one class of offering sold under the brand. Existing methods may collect data of the customer shopping for products of the brand of interest and provide recommendations for offerings outside of the class of interest, causing the customer to receive recommendations for products that they are not interested in purchasing. Manually associating offerings into specific groupings and sub-groupings of offerings can partially improve the accuracy of product recommendations, but, as described previously, the process of manually offering association requires significant human labor. Using existing methods, a human operator must manually inspect the groupings of offerings to determine that there are two classes of good associated with the same brand and further must have the skill or experience to recognize that a customer may be interested in only one class of good. Conversely, a descriptor taxonomy can be used to organize brand as sub-nodes of each class of goods with significantly less labor and by operators with less skill or experience. Each offering for sale can be assigned descriptors for both brand and class and a descriptor taxonomy can be organized such that nodes for brand are in a child layer of the nodes for class of offering. In this example, a human operator would only be required to have the skill or experience to recognize that class of offering is likely to produce more accurate product recommendations than recommendations based on brand alone. A processor, such as processor **112**, can then automatically narrow the list of

recommendations first by class of good and then by brand, according to the organizational structure of the descriptor taxonomy to provide product recommendations that are tailored to a customer's interests and that include fewer, if any, unrelated offerings than existing methods. The above non-limiting examples illustrate the advantages in organizing an inventory of offerings and in determining relationships between products provided by descriptor taxonomies described herein.

(43) Further, the use of a descriptor taxonomy can significantly reduce the human labor required to add new offerings to an ecommerce website inventory. Adding new offerings to an inventory requires new products to be manually associated to existing offering groups, which is a time-consuming process usually requiring significant human labor. A human operator is required to first determine what groupings of offerings exist, and then make a subjective decision about what group(s) the new offerings should belong to. Conversely, adding new offerings to an inventory for which there is a descriptor taxonomy only requires that the new products be labeled with descriptors of the descriptor taxonomy. Further, if the new offerings have characteristics not shared by existing products, one or more new nodes can be added to appropriate locations of the descriptor taxonomy which can then be used to automatically generate relationships between offerings. Conversely, using existing methods, a human operator is required to subjectively determine whether the new products are similar enough to be associated with an existing product grouping and/or whether a new product grouping should be created.

(44) Further, the use of a hierarchical taxonomy can reduce the overall number of descriptors required to describe an inventory of offerings by storing information about offering relatedness through the hierarchical structure of the taxonomy. Prior methods may, for example, require that related products be manually associated. The use of a hierarchical taxonomy requires only that the descriptors for those related products be related through the organizational structure of the taxonomy. In this manner, the use of a hierarchical taxonomy also reduces the overall workload, including both computational load and human labor, required to label related products in a large inventory of offerings.

(45) Further, organizing offering descriptors rather than offerings significantly reduces the workload required to organize and create a hierarchical taxonomy, especially for ecommerce websites offering for sale a large number of offerings. The hierarchical structure of the taxonomy allows a limited number of offering descriptors to describe and capture all offerings of a large inventory by associating offering descriptors of related products through parent-child node relationships established by the edges of the hierarchical taxonomy.

(46) While descriptor taxonomy **152** has been described herein as relating generally to the identification of related offerings and the creation of offering recommendations, the organizational structure of descriptor taxonomy **152** can also be used to create targeted promotional content for products a customer may be interested in. As outlined in the above-described examples, related products can be identified through the use of a descriptor taxonomy with significant more accuracy and in a significantly more efficient manner than allowed by existing methods. Promotional content for those related products can also be displayed to the customer to improve customer engagement with ecommerce website **162**, potentially increasing the likelihood that the customer purchases an offering from ecommerce website **162**. The promotional content can be created by, for example, one or more programs of custom video module **150**.

(47) Profiling criteria **154** are criteria for determining a customer's likely preference between different options within categories of goods. Profiling criteria **154** are structured according to the structure of descriptor taxonomy **152**. Profiling criteria **154** includes two hierarchically-arranged levels of criteria for determining customer preferences. The relationship between the levels of profiling criteria **154** and descriptor taxonomy **152** is indicated by dashed lines **156A** and **156B**. Profiling criteria **154** indicates that the customer's preference between the offerings described by nodes A and B should be determined first, as shown by dashed line **156A**. The customer's preference regarding the next level of descriptor hierarchy **152** can then be determined, as shown

by dashed line **156B**. Specifically, if the customer is determined to prefer the offerings described by the descriptor represented by node A, profiling criteria **154** indicates that the customer's preference between the offerings described by the descriptors represented by nodes C and D. Similarly, if the customer is determined to prefer the offerings described by the descriptor represented by node B, profiling criteria **154** indicates that the customer's preference between the offerings described by the descriptors represented by nodes E and F. Customer profile module **130** can use profiling criteria **154** to create customer descriptors for a customer profile. Customer profile module **130** can determine customer preference at each tier of profiling criteria

(48) Profiling criteria **154** are specific to a particular descriptor taxonomy **152** and are created after a descriptor taxonomy **152** has been created for the offerings sold on ecommerce website **162**. Descriptor taxonomy **152** and/or profiling criteria **154** can be constructed by a human operator and stored on memory **114**. Additionally and/or alternatively, descriptor taxonomy **152** and/or profiling criteria **154** can be created automatically by one or more programs stored on memory **114** and executed by processor **112**.

(49) Custom offering recommendations **164** are visually-perceptible information, such as text, icons, and/or images, that describe the custom set of offerings created by offering recommendation module **140**. Custom offering recommendations **164** can also include aurally-perceptible information, such as one or more audio files. Custom offering recommendations **164** can be created and inserted into a web page of ecommerce website **162** by website modification module **160**. The modified web page including custom offering recommendations **164** can be transmitted to a user device **106A-N** of a customer **186A-N** browsing ecommerce website **162**. The customer **186A-N** can then purchase one of the offerings included in custom offering recommendations **164** by interacting with ecommerce website **162**.

(50) Custom video **166** is a custom video created by custom video module **150** and viewable by a customer **186A-N** browsing ecommerce website **162**. Custom video **166** includes visual and/or audio elements that are perceptible by a customer interacting with ecommerce website **162**. Custom video **166** can be inserted into a web page of ecommerce website **162**. The modified web page including custom video **166** can be transmitted to a user device **106A-N** of a customer **186A-N** browsing ecommerce website. The customer **186A-N** can view custom video **166** to learn more about offerings linked to the customer's profile. In some examples, the modified web page requires the customer **186A-N** to interact with one or more buttons (e.g., click a web player) to view custom video **166**. In other examples, the modified web page causes custom video **166** to automatically play. In at least some examples, the modified web page that includes custom video **166** is also modified to include custom offering recommendations **164**. In other examples, custom video **166** and custom offering recommendations **164** are inserted into different web pages of ecommerce website **162**.

(51) Preference questionnaire **168** includes one or more questions that a customer **186A-N** can answer by interacting with ecommerce website **162**. The questions are designed to determine preferences according to the profiling criteria **154** for the descriptor taxonomy **152** for the offerings sold on ecommerce website **162**. A customer **186A-N** can answer questions of preference questionnaire **168** by interacting with ecommerce website **162**. For example, preference questionnaire **168** can include one or more clickable buttons or other web page elements that a customer use to indicate a preference according to profiling criteria **154**. Customer profile module **130** can use the answers to preference questionnaire **168** to create customer descriptors for a customer profile, which can then be used to create a custom set of offerings and/or a custom video by offering recommendation module **140** and/or custom video module **150**, respectively.

(52) FIG. 2 is a schematic diagram of an example of a descriptor taxonomy **252**, which is similar to descriptor taxonomy **152** but includes three hierarchical layers of offering descriptors and includes nodes having varying numbers of child nodes. Like descriptor taxonomy **152**, descriptor **252** is a non-limiting example and is included for explanatory purposes. Server system **10** suitable for use

with the web computer system of FIG. 1. Descriptor taxonomy includes starting node 256, descriptor nodes 260A-P, and edges 266A-P organized into hierarchical layers 270A-C.

(53) Descriptor nodes 260A-P correspond to offering descriptors that describe the inventory of offerings of an ecommerce website 162. Starting node 256 is a zero-layer node and does not correspond to any offering descriptors. Rather, starting node 256 can be used as a starting point to search sequentially through layers 270A, 270B, 270C of descriptor taxonomy 252. Edges 266A-P indicate the relationship between the nodes (i.e., starting node 256 and descriptor nodes 260A-P). Nodes 260A-P that are connected by an edge 266A-P or a continuous chain of nodes 260A-P and edges 266A-P are referred to herein as “parent nodes” or “child nodes” based on their relative position in hierarchical layers 270A-C. For example, nodes 260A and 260C are parent nodes of node 260G, and nodes 260C and 260G are child nodes of node 260A. Each group of child nodes in the same layer 270A, 270B, 270C corresponds to the same category for categorizing the offerings offered on the ecommerce website 162. Within a given lineage (i.e., a sequence of connected nodes and edges spanning layers 270A-C), different layers 270A, 270B, 270C correspond to different categories for categorizing offerings.

(54) As described previously, in examples where a category applies to all goods, it may be appropriate for all nodes of a single layer to correspond to that category. In examples where a category only applies to a subset of goods, it may be appropriate for only certain nodes having a common parent node to correspond to one category for characterizing goods. Referring to descriptor taxonomy 252 as a specific example, each of groups of nodes 260G-H, 260I-K, 260L-M, and 260Q can correspond to a different category for characterizing goods. In other examples, all of nodes 260G-Q can correspond to the same category for characterizing goods. In yet further examples, some groups of nodes 260G-H, 260I-K, 260L-M, and 260Q can correspond to the same category for characterizing goods and others of 260G-H, 260I-K, 260L-M, and 260Q can correspond to different categories for characterizing goods. For examples, nodes 260G-H and 260I-K can correspond to a first category, nodes 260L-M can correspond to a second category, and node 260Q can correspond to a third category. The above examples are non-limiting and are provided to illustrate various ways that nodes of descriptor taxonomy 252 can be organized.

(55) The nodes of the top hierarchical layer 270A of descriptor taxonomy 252 generally correspond to different offering descriptors. However, the same offering descriptor may occur in multiple groups of child nodes in lower hierarchical layers 270B, 270C. For example, nodes 260C and 260E can be the same offering descriptor. If, for example, layer 270A corresponds to technology type and layer 270B corresponds to business need for the child nodes of both nodes 266A and 266B, it is possible for the same business need to be met by offerings targeting different technology types. As such, both nodes 260A and 260B would have child nodes in layer 270B corresponding to the same business need.

(56) In this example, descriptor taxonomy 252 includes three layers 270A, 270B, 270C of nodes corresponding to offering descriptors. Nodes 260A and 260B are located in the top hierarchical layer 270A and are connected to starting node 256 by edges 266A and 266B, respectively. Nodes 260C, 260D, 260E, and 260F are located in middle hierarchical layer 270B. Nodes 260C and 260D are connected to node 260A by edges 266C and 266D, respectively. Nodes 260E and 260F are connected to node 260B by edges 266E and 266F, respectively. Nodes 260G, 260H, 260I, 260J, 260K, 260L, 260M, and 260P are located in lower hierarchical layer 270C. Nodes 260G and 260H are connected to node 260C by edges 266G and 266H, respectively. Nodes 260I, 260J, 260K are connected to node 260D by edges 266I, 266J, and 266K, respectively. Nodes 260L and 260M are connected to node 260E by edges 266L and 266M, respectively. Node 260P is connected to node 260F by edge 266P.

(57) Processor 112 inspects descriptor taxonomy 252 to identify nodes that have a descriptor that matches or corresponds to a customer descriptor in a downward manner. As described previously, searching a taxonomy in a “downward” manner refers to searching from a zero-level root node

(e.g., starting node **256**) to a terminal layer of child nodes (e.g., nodes **260G-Q** of hierarchical layer **270C**). Specifically, processor **112** first determines whether a customer descriptor matches the offering descriptor of node **260A** or node **260B**. Depending on the results of the comparison, processor **112** then determines whether a second customer descriptor matches the services offering descriptor of one of nodes **260C-D** or one of nodes **260E-F**. Depending on the results of the second comparison, processor **112** then determines whether a third customer descriptor matches the offering descriptor of one of nodes **260G-H**, nodes **260I-K**, nodes **260L-M**, or nodes **260P-P**. As a specific example, if the descriptor of node **260A** matches a customer descriptor of the customer profile, processor **112** then determine whether the descriptor of node **260C** or node **260D** matches a customer descriptor. If the descriptor of node **260D** matches a customer descriptor, processor **112** proceeds by determining whether a descriptor of nodes **260I**, **260J**, or **260K** matches a customer descriptor.

(58) In some examples, a customer profile can include customer descriptors that match or correspond to the offering descriptors of multiple nodes that are in the same layer **270A**, **270B**, **270C** and are connected to the same parent node. For example, a customer profile can include customer descriptors that match or correspond to the offering descriptors of both nodes **260C** and **260D**. In this example, processor **112** would continue inspecting taxonomy **252** in a downward manner from both nodes **260C** and **260D**. Specifically, processor **112** would inspect nodes **260G**, **260H** and would also inspect nodes **260I**, **260J**, **260K** for offering descriptors that correspond to or match customer descriptors of the customer profile. A customer profile can include customer descriptors that correspond to multiple available options in the same hierarchical layer **270A**, **270B**, **270C** where the customer is open to multiple options, has multiple interests, and/or does not have a strong preference in the category represented by the hierarchical layer hierarchical layer **270A**, **270B**, **270C**.

(59) If processor **112** encounters a layer of descriptor taxonomy **252** having no offering descriptors that correspond to any customer descriptors of a customer profile, processor **112** can continue to search for offering descriptors that match or correspond to a customer descriptor in the children in of those nodes. For example, if the offering descriptor of node **260A** corresponds to a customer descriptor, but neither of the offering descriptors of nodes **260C** and **260D** correspond to customer descriptors, processor **112** can then search all of nodes **260G-K**. If processor **112** finds a match among those child nodes, the offering descriptors for the child node as well as the appropriate parent node can be stored in the set of offerings used to make a custom set of offerings (i.e., with one or more programs of offering recommendation module **140**) and/or to make a custom video (i.e., with one or more programs of custom video module **150**). If no offering descriptors in the child layer match a customer descriptor, processor **112** can proceed through subsequent child nodes (if any remain) to search for an offering descriptor that corresponds to a customer descriptor. If no further offering descriptors remain, processor **112** can store in the set of offering descriptors all offering descriptors for all child nodes of the lowest node of descriptor taxonomy **252** matched to a customer descriptor. Similarly, if processor **112** matches all customer descriptors before inspecting all layers of descriptor taxonomy **252**, processor **112** can store in the set of offering descriptors all offering descriptors for all child nodes of the lowest node of descriptor taxonomy **252** matched to a customer descriptor.

(60) Searching descriptor taxonomy **252** in a downward manner allows for the largest number of descriptors organized by descriptor taxonomy **252** to be removed from the set of offering descriptors used to generate the custom set of offerings. For example, understanding that a customer has a preference for offerings related to the descriptor placed in node A of descriptor taxonomy **252** rather than offerings related to the descriptor placed in node B allows for the descriptors in nodes **260E**, **260F**, **260L**, **260M**, and **260P** to be excluded from the set of offering descriptors used to generate the custom set of offerings. Conversely, starting at the customer's preference for, for example, the offerings represented by the descriptors in nodes **260G** and **260H**

only allows one of nodes **260G** and **260H** to be excluded from the set of offering descriptors used to generate the custom set of offerings.

(61) In examples where it is advantageous to characterize offerings with more than three categories of descriptors, descriptor taxonomy **252** can include more than three hierarchically-arranged layers of nodes corresponding to offering descriptors. Similarly, if it is advantageous to have only two categories of descriptors for characterizing offerings, descriptor taxonomy **252** can be adapted to have only two hierarchically-arranged layers of nodes.

(62) Descriptor taxonomy **252** is an example of a descriptor taxonomy for a set of offerings where some subsets of offerings have more variety and/or meeting a wider range of customer needs, interests, and/or preferences. For example, node **260D** includes three child nodes, which is more than nodes **260C**, **260E**, and **260F**. Node **260D** accordingly includes a more diverse array of offerings than nodes **260C**, **260E**, and **260F**. Similarly, node **260F** includes only a single child node, meaning that node **260F** includes a less diverse array of offerings than nodes **260C**, **260D**, or **260E**. In other examples, it is possible for the nodes of descriptor taxonomy **252** to have a different arrangement, such that each of nodes **260A-F** can have a different number of child nodes.

(63) The number of child nodes and the number of hierarchically-arranged layers are determined in an inventory-specific manner, as different ecommerce websites **162** can offer different ranges of services that can be characterized using different sets of offering descriptors. FIG. **3** is a flow diagram of method **300**, which is a method of creating a hierarchically-arranged descriptor taxonomy for organizing offering descriptors. Method **300** includes steps **302-306** of labeling a plurality of offerings with descriptors (step **302**), determining the frequency of each descriptor (step **304**), and constructing a taxonomy according to the descriptor frequencies and the relationships between descriptors (step **306**). Method **300** can be used to create descriptor taxonomies **152**, **252** or any other descriptor taxonomy based on a list of all offerings offered by an ecommerce website.

(64) In step **302**, a plurality of offerings is labeled with offering descriptors. Categories describing the plurality of offerings can and descriptors to distinguish offerings within each category can be created. The number of categories as well as the descriptors for each category can be determined based on the complexity of the offerings, industry norms, likely customer needs, potential customer preferences, or another business need. Once the descriptors are created, each offering can be labeled with one descriptor for each category to create a labeled set of offerings that can be used with subsequent steps of method **300**. In some examples, the categories and/or descriptors can be created using one or more programs stored on memory **114** of server system **10** (FIG. **1**).

(65) In step **304**, the frequency of each descriptor among the labeled set of offerings is determined. The frequency of each descriptor can be counted and used to hierarchically arrange categories of descriptors. For example, where the frequency of each descriptor of a particular category is relatively even among the total set of offerings, placing frequently-occurring descriptors in a higher layer of a descriptor taxonomy can allow for a larger number of child nodes, and thus a larger number of offering descriptors, to be excluded from subsequent analysis of the descriptor taxonomy with other customer descriptors of the customer profile. In this manner, placing higher-occurring descriptors in a higher layer of a descriptor taxonomy can significantly simplify the analysis performed by processor **112** to create a set of offering descriptors that are applicable to a customer.

(66) In step **306**, the taxonomy is constructed according to the descriptor frequencies determined in step **304** and the relationships between the descriptors to be organized in the taxonomy. Descriptors occurring more frequently can be placed as nodes in higher layers of the descriptor taxonomy, providing the advantages outlined in the discussion of step **304**. However, in some examples where the frequency of each descriptor is not even among the total set of offerings, one descriptor may describe a sufficiently large portion of offerings such that placing the descriptors of that category at a high level of the descriptor taxonomy may not allow for a large number of offerings to be excluded at that level. In these examples, it may be advantageous for a category of descriptors

having a more even distribution among offerings to be placed at a higher level of the descriptor taxonomy.

(67) Based on the frequency analysis, nodes can be created that link to a starting node (e.g., starting node **256** of descriptor taxonomy **252**; FIG. 2), where each node represents one offering descriptor of the same category. The next category to be included in the descriptor taxonomy can be determined based on a frequency analysis of the remaining offering descriptors. Based on the co-occurrence of descriptors of the top layer and descriptors of the second layer in labeled offerings of the labeled set of offerings created in step **302**, nodes can be placed in the second layer with edges connecting the second-layer nodes to nodes in the top layer, such only descriptors assigned to a common offering of the labeled set of offerings are linked with an edge. This process can be repeated for all remaining offering descriptors to complete the descriptor taxonomy.

(68) Method **300** is only one example of a method of creating a descriptor taxonomy and other methods can be used to create a descriptor taxonomy. In other examples, method **300** can be modified to include other optimization methods for creating an optimal descriptor taxonomy.

(69) FIG. 4 is a flow diagram of method **400**, which is a method of creating a customer profile. Method **400** includes steps **402-406** of creating profiling criteria based on a descriptor taxonomy (step **402**), presenting an ecommerce website to a customer (step **403**), collecting electronic customer data of customer interactions with an ecommerce website (step **404**), determining customer descriptors (step **406**), and determining whether there have been changes to the descriptor taxonomy (step **408**). The customer profile created using method **400** includes customer descriptors suitable for use with other methods described herein to determine a set of offering descriptors using a descriptor taxonomy.

(70) In step **402**, profiling criteria are created based on a descriptor taxonomy. The descriptor taxonomy can be, for example, descriptor taxonomy **152** (FIG. 1), descriptor taxonomy **252** (FIG. 2), a descriptor taxonomy according to method **300**, or any other suitable descriptor taxonomy. As described previously, a hierarchical descriptor taxonomy organizes offering descriptors into hierarchical layers. Each layer can correspond to a category for characterizing offerings and the profiling criteria can be created to determine a customer's likely preference, interest, and/or need within a particular category. The profiling criteria can also include separate criteria for each branch point within a given hierarchical layer (e.g., profiling criteria **154** of FIG. 1).

(71) The profiling criteria created by step **402** are designed to be able to create customer descriptors based on electronic customer data extracted from ecommerce website **162**. Each criterion of the profiling criteria is selected to be able to distinguish a customer's likely preference between offerings described by descriptors in a given level of a descriptor taxonomy and/or linked to a single branch point. Electronic customer data received from ecommerce website **162** can be compared against each criterion of the profiling criteria to create customer descriptors that describe a customer's preference, interest, and/or needs at each layer and/or branch point of the descriptor taxonomy.

(72) In at least some examples, the profiling criteria includes a questionnaire of one or more questions for determining a customer's likely preference, interest and/or need within a particular category. The questions can also be specific to each branch point within a hierarchical layer of the descriptor taxonomy. The questionnaire can be inserted into a web page of ecommerce website **162** as an interactable element, such that a customer **186A-N** can answer the questions of the questionnaire by interacting with ecommerce website **162** through user device **106A-N**.

(73) Profiling criteria created in step **402**, like other profiling criteria described herein, are specific to a particular descriptor taxonomy and can be used to create multiple customer profiles for multiple customers. Once step **402** is performed for a given descriptor taxonomy, step **402** can be omitted in subsequent iterations of method **400** that create a customer profile according to that descriptor taxonomy. However, if the descriptor taxonomy changes due to, for example, changes to the inventory of offerings offered on ecommerce website **162**, step **402** should be repeated to create

new profiling criteria for creating customer descriptors of a customer profile.

(74) In step **403**, ecommerce website **162** is presented to a customer **186A-N**. As described previously, ecommerce website **162** includes one or more offerings that are available for purchase by a customer **186A-N** browsing ecommerce website **162** with a user device **106A-N**. The descriptor taxonomy used to generate the profiling criteria in step **402** organizes offering descriptors that describe the offerings offered on ecommerce website **162**. Webserver **102** can present ecommerce website **162** to a customer **186A-N** by transmitting data from ecommerce website **162** to the customer's user device **106A-N**.

(75) In step **404**, electronic customer data of a customer's interactions with the ecommerce website are collected. The electronic customer data are collected by, for example, inspecting and/or analyzing the browsing history on ecommerce website **162** of a customer **186A-N**. The electronic customer data can also be collected by a customer's questions to a questionnaire. The questionnaire can be, for example, preference questionnaire **168**, or another suitable questionnaire. In at least some examples, the electronic customer data can be collected and associated with the customer automatically. For example, application server **100**, webserver **102**, or another component of server system **10** (FIG. **1**) can automatically collect electronic customer data for each customer **186A-N** based on an internet protocol address another suitable property of the customer's user device **106A-N**. In some examples, electronic customer data for a customer can be collected over repeated visits to ecommerce website **162** based on the internet protocol address or other suitable property of the customer's user device **106A-N**. Tracking a customer's activity on ecommerce website **162** over multiple visits allows for a larger sampling of electronic customer data to be used to create customer descriptors in subsequent step **406**, potentially increasing the accuracy with which the customer is described by the customer descriptors.

(76) In some examples, processor **112** can collect the electronic customer data in step **404** through the use of both a questionnaire and the passive collection of other data, such as browsing history. For example, processor **112** can use browsing history data to determine a first customer descriptor according to the profiling criteria. Processor **112** can then examine browsing history data to determine whether the data can be used to create a second customer descriptor according to the next criteria of the profiling criteria. If processor **112** cannot create the second customer descriptor, processor **112** can cause ecommerce website **162** to display a question of a questionnaire that a customer can answer to provide the information required to create the second customer descriptor. Processor **112** can repeat that process for each subsequent profiling criterion of the profiling criteria.

(77) In step **406**, customer descriptors are determined using the electronic customer data collected in step **404** and the profiling criteria created in step **402**. Processor **112** can inspect and/or analyze the electronic customer data with the profiling criteria to create customer descriptors that describe the customer's interests, needs, and/or preferences according to the profiling criteria. The customer descriptors can then be stored to a customer profile. In some examples, step **406** can be performed to create new customer descriptors each time a customer visits ecommerce website **162**.

Additionally and/or alternatively, the customer descriptors created during step **406** can be stored to a customer profile that is associated with an internet protocol address or another suitable property of the customer's user device **106A-N**. For example, the customer descriptors created based on a customer's initial interaction with ecommerce website **162** can be created and stored to the customer's profile, and then steps **403-406** can be repeated during subsequent visits to ecommerce website **162**, allowing for comparison and tracking of the customer's customer descriptors through iterative adjustment over time, as new electronic customer data becomes available in real time.

(78) In examples where method **400** is only performed once, method **400** stops at step **406**. If method **400** is performed iteratively to create customer profiles for multiple customers or to iteratively adjust a customer's customer descriptors, method **400** proceeds to step **408** after step **406**. In step **408**, processor **112** determines whether there have been changes to the descriptor

taxonomy the most-recent iteration of step **406**. Method **400** can be repeated by proceeding back to step **402** or **403** according to the determination made in step **408**. Processor **112** can determine whether there has been a change and/or update to the descriptor taxonomy stored to memory **114**. Processor **112** can inspect, for example, metadata describing a history of changes to the descriptor taxonomy to determine whether the descriptor taxonomy has been updated. If processor **112** determines that the taxonomy has been updated, method **400** proceeds to step **402** to create new profiling criteria. If processor **112** determines that the taxonomy has not been updated, method **400** proceeds to step **403** to create one or more new customer descriptors using previously-created profiling criteria.

(79) Where profiling criteria includes more than one criterion, each criterion can be compared against the electronic customer data collected in step **404** to determine a customer descriptor for each criterion. FIG. 5 depicts method **450**, which is a method of determining customer descriptors in step **406** of method **400**. Method **450** includes steps **452-460** of determining a first customer descriptor (step **452**), determining a second customer descriptor (step **454**), determining a third customer descriptor (step **456**), determining a fourth customer descriptor (step **458**) and determining a fifth customer descriptor (step **460**).

(80) Method **450** allows for the creation of customer descriptors for five criteria of a set of profiling criteria created according to step **402** of method **400**. Specifically, a first customer descriptor can be determined in step **452** based on a first profiling criterion and the electronic customer data, a second customer descriptor can be determined in step **454** based on a second profiling criterion and the electronic customer data, a third customer descriptor can be determined in step **456** based on a third profiling criterion and the electronic customer data, a fourth customer descriptor can be determined in step **458** based on a fourth profiling criterion and the electronic customer data, and a fifth customer descriptor can be determined in step **460** based on a fifth profiling criterion and the electronic customer data. Method **450** is depicted as including steps for creating five customer descriptors for exemplary purposes, and in other examples method **450** can be adapted to create any number of customer descriptors for any number of profiling criteria.

(81) Step **406** of method **400** and/or all steps of method **450** can be performed automatically by server system **10** (FIG. 1) and can be performed concurrently or substantially concurrently with the collection of electronic customer data in step **404**. Processor **112** or another processor of server system **10** can be used to perform step **406** and/or method **450** concurrently with step **404** of method **400**. Performing steps **406** and/or method **450** concurrently with step **404** allows for the customer's customer profile to be automatically created and updated as the customer is browsing ecommerce website **162**, allowing recommendations to be created using method **500** (FIG. 6; discussed in more detail subsequently) and custom videos to be created using method **600** (FIG. 8; discussed in more detail subsequently) while the customer is browsing ecommerce website **162**. As such, performing step **406** and/or method **450** concurrently to the collection of electronic customer data allows for web pages of ecommerce website **162** to be updated in real-time or near real-time to improve the customer's browsing and/or shopping experience on ecommerce website **162** as the customer is browsing and/or shopping.

(82) FIG. 6 is a flow diagram of method **500**, which is a method of creating a custom set of offerings based on a customer profile and a descriptor taxonomy. Method **500** includes steps **502-508** of creating a customer profile (step **502**), determining a set of offerings associated with customer descriptors of the customer profile (step **504**), generating a custom set of offerings (step **506**), and updating the ecommerce website to display the custom set of offerings (step **508**).

(83) In step **502**, a customer profile is created. The customer profile is created using profiling criteria based on the descriptor taxonomy of the offering descriptors of the inventory of offerings of ecommerce website **162**. The customer profile includes at least one customer descriptor generated using the profiling criteria and electronic customer data describing customer interactions with ecommerce website **162**. The customer profile can be created in step **502** by performing method

400 (FIG. 4) and, in some examples, method **450** (FIG. 5). As described with respect to methods **400** and **450**, processor **112** can perform step **502** concurrently to the collection of electronic customer data in step **404** of method **400** to enable the custom set of offerings generated in step **506** to be created in real-time or substantially in real-time.

(84) In step **504**, a set of offering descriptors associated with customer descriptors of the customer profile (i.e., the customer profile created in step **502**) is determined. Offering descriptors are determined using the same descriptor taxonomy used to generate profiling criteria for creating the customer profile in step **502**. Processor **112** can determine offering descriptors by analyzing the descriptor taxonomy in a downward manner with the customer descriptors for the customer. More specifically, beginning at the starting node of the descriptor taxonomy, processor **112** can determine which node(s) of all nodes connected to the starting node matches a customer descriptor of the customer profile. Processor **112** can then inspect the child nodes of that node to search for another match. Processor **112** can continue moving downward through the descriptor taxonomy until all customer descriptors of the customer profile have been matched to an offering descriptor of a node of the descriptor taxonomy. All matched offering descriptors are stored to as the set of offering descriptors. The set of offering descriptors can be used with step **506** of method **500** or with another method described herein. Processor **112** can perform step **504** using one or more programs of offering recommendation module **140** (FIG. 1). The set of offering descriptors can be stored to, for example, memory **114** of application server **100** (FIG. 1) or another suitable device.

(85) As described previously with respect to the discussion of descriptor taxonomy **252** (FIG. 2), if two or more customer descriptors match the offering descriptors of a particular hierarchical layer of the descriptor taxonomy, processor can inspect the child nodes of all matched nodes of that layer, and continue moving downward through both branches of the descriptor taxonomy. Further, in some examples where no customer descriptors match the offerings of a particular hierarchical layer, processor **112** can continue moving downward through all possible branches of the descriptor taxonomy until processor **112** finds a node having an offering descriptor matching a customer descriptor of the customer profile.

(86) In step **506**, a custom set of offerings is generated based on the set of offering descriptors created during step **504**. The custom set of offerings are offerings in which the customer is likely to be interested based on the customer descriptors of their customer profile. Processor **112** can query a database that associates offering descriptors and offering with the set of offering descriptors generated in step **504** to generate offerings in which the customer may be interested. Those offerings returned from the query can be stored as the custom set of offerings and used with step **508** of method **500**. The database queried in step **506** can be database **172** of database server **104** (FIG. 1) or another suitable database that relates offering descriptors and offerings.

(87) The custom set of offerings generated in step **506** can include the names or titles, offering information, offering documentation, visually-perceptible elements, and/or aurally-perceptible elements for each offering of the custom set of offerings. The visually-perceptible elements can be, for example, one or more photos or videos of the offering, among other options. The aurally-perceptible elements can be, for example, one or more spoken descriptions of the offering, among other options.

(88) In step **508**, ecommerce website **162** is updated to display the custom set of offerings. Processor **112** can automatically update a web page of ecommerce website **162** to include one or more visually-perceptible elements and/or aurally-perceptible elements describing the offerings. The visually- and/or aurally-perceptible elements can include offering descriptions, offering names and/or titles, links to offerings description pages, offering documentation, or offering images, among other options.

(89) Ecommerce website **162** is generally configured to be able to present a generic set of offerings to a customer before step **508** is performed. The generic set of offerings are not specific to any particular customer and can be selected based on, for example, overall popularity or another

suitable quality. When ecommerce website **162** is updated in step **508**, the custom set of offerings are displayed on a web page of ecommerce website **162** instead of the generic set of offerings. As such, updating ecommerce website **162** personalizes the browsing experience of each customer browsing ecommerce website **162**.

(90) Processor **112** can use one or more programs to of website modification module **160** to update ecommerce website **162** to display the custom set of offerings. The web page modified in step **508** can be a page for browsing offerings offered on ecommerce website **162**. In some examples, ecommerce website can be queried or searched by a customer **186A-N** and processor **112** search only the custom set of offerings to provide results to the customer **186A-N**.

(91) Like step **502**, steps **504** and **506** of method **500** can be performed automatically and concurrently with the collection of electronic customer data used to create the customer profile. As such, the custom set of offerings can be created concurrently and in real-time or substantially real-time as the customer browses ecommerce website **162**. Step **508** of method **500** can be performed automatically once step **506** is completed, such that a customer browsing ecommerce website **162** can quickly or, in some examples, immediately presented with an updated web page containing the custom set of offerings. Advantageously, this can improve a customer's browsing experience, potentially increasing the number of purchases made on ecommerce website **162** and increasing the likelihood that the customer will return to ecommerce website **162** to make subsequent or repeat purchases.

(92) FIG. **7** is a flow diagram of method **550**, which is a method of identifying nodes of a descriptor taxonomy based on a customer profile. Method **550** can be used to perform step **504** of method **500** and includes steps **552-562** of identifying a first node (step **562**), identifying a child node of the first node as a second node (step **564**), identifying a child node of the second node as a third node (step **566**), identifying a child node of the third node as a fourth node (step **568**), identifying a child node of the fourth node as a fifth node (step **560**), and identifying all child nodes of the lowest node (step **562**).

(93) In step **562**, a first node is identified. Processor **112** compares nodes of a descriptor taxonomy in a downward manner, starting from a starting node (e.g., a zero-level node) of the descriptor taxonomy, until processor **112** encounters a node for an offering descriptor corresponding to one of the customer descriptors of the customer profile. The highest node that corresponds to one of the customer descriptors of the customer profile is stored as the first node. The offering descriptor of the first node is stored in the set of offering descriptors for the customer.

(94) In step **554**, a child node of the first node is identified as a second node. Processor **112** compares nodes of descriptor taxonomy that are children of the first node and stores the child node at the highest level of the descriptor taxonomy that has an offering descriptor matching or corresponding to a customer descriptor of the customer profile as the second node. In at least some examples, the second node is an immediate child node of the first node. Processor **112** stores the offering descriptor of the second node, as well as the offering descriptors of any nodes intervening between the first and second nodes, in the set of offering descriptors for the customer.

(95) Steps **556-560** are performed in substantially the same manner as step **554**, but are performed by inspecting the child nodes of the lowest identified node of the descriptor taxonomy. The lowest node is generally the most-recently identified node and is at the lowest level of the descriptor taxonomy among the identified nodes.

(96) After all customer descriptors have been matched to nodes of the descriptor taxonomy, method **550** proceeds to step **562**. In step **562**, all child nodes of the lowest node are identified and their respective offering descriptors are stored to the set of offering descriptors. Advantageously, this allows for all descriptors of the child nodes of the identified nodes to also be incorporated into the set of offering descriptors used to, for example, query the database and generate the custom set of offerings in step **506** of method **500**.

(97) As indicated by the arrows between steps of method **550**, step **562** can be performed after any

of steps **552-560** based on when all customer descriptors have been matched to nodes of the descriptor taxonomy. For example, if the customer profile contains only three customer descriptors, method **550** can proceed to step **562** after step **556** and steps **558** and **560** can be omitted from method **550**. Further, method **550** can also stop when processor **112** reaches a terminal branch node (i.e., a node having no child nodes) of the descriptor taxonomy. For example, if the descriptor taxonomy only includes four layers of nodes, method **550** can stop after step **558** and steps **560** and **562** can be omitted. In further examples, method **550** can include additional steps to identify nodes lower than the fifth node before all child nodes of the lowest node are identified in step **562**.

Method **550** can include additional steps to identify additional nodes (e.g., a sixth, seventh, or eighth node) where descriptor taxonomy has more than five layers of nodes and the customer profile includes descriptors corresponding to more than five layers of the descriptor taxonomy.

(98) In some examples, more than one customer descriptor can match more than one same hierarchical layer of the descriptor taxonomy. In these examples, processor **112** can begin performing additional iterations of method **550** starting at each additional matched node. For example, if two customer descriptors match two nodes that are children of the first node, one node can be treated as the second node of the first instance of method **550** and processor **112** can begin a second instance of method **550** to continue examining child nodes of the second matched node.

(99) While method **550** has been generally described herein with respect to step **506** of method **500**, method **550** can also be used to perform step **606** of method **600**, discussed subsequently with respect to FIG. **8**. Advantageously, method **550** provides a versatile method for exhaustively searching a descriptor taxonomy with a customer profile to identify nodes of the descriptor taxonomy forming a continuous lineage and thereby allowing a set of offering descriptors describing products a customer is likely to be interested in.

(100) Method **550** can be performed by processor **112** concurrently with the collection of electronic customer data used to create the customer profile (e.g., concurrently with step **404** of method **400**; FIG. **4**). Advantageously, this allows a complex descriptor taxonomy to be thoroughly searched to create a complete set of offering descriptors concurrently or substantially concurrently with the customer's browsing of ecommerce website **162**, thereby allowing subsequent steps that use the set of offerings to also be performed concurrently or substantially concurrently with the customer's browsing and further allowing ecommerce website **162** to be quickly or immediately updated or modified based on the customer's likely preferences. As compared to methods that do not use a hierarchical descriptor taxonomy, method **550** and other methods disclosed herein reduce the computational load required to create a custom set of offering descriptors that describe offerings in which a customer is likely to be interested.

(101) FIG. **8** is a flow diagram of method **600**, which is a method of method of creating a custom video based on a customer profile. Method **600** can be used to create custom video **166** of ecommerce website **162** (FIG. **1**) and includes steps **602-610** of creating a customer profile (step **602**), determining a set of offering descriptors associated with customer descriptors of a customer profile (step **604**), selecting a subset of video segments based on the set of offering descriptors (step **606**), creating a custom video from the subset of video segments (step **608**), and modifying a web page of an ecommerce website by inserting the custom video (step **610**). The custom video created using method **600** relates to products described offering descriptors corresponding to customer descriptors, and can be used for advertising or promotional purposes to help motivate a customer to purchase a product on ecommerce website **162**.

(102) In step **602**, a customer profile is created. The customer profile can be created in the same way as described previously with respect to step **502** of method **500**. In some examples, a single customer profile can be created for use with both methods **500** and **600**, and one of steps **502** and **602** can be omitted.

(103) In step **604**, a set of offering descriptors associated with customer descriptors of the customer profile are determined. Step **604** can be performed in the same way as described previously with

respect to step **504** of method **500**. In some examples, a single set of offering descriptors can be created for use with both methods **500** and **600**, and one of steps **502** and **602** can be omitted.

(104) In step **606**, a subset of video segments of a plurality of video segments is selected based on the set of offering descriptors. A database of server system **10**, such as database **172** of database server **104**, can store a plurality of pre-recorded video segments discussing various products and offerings that are offered on ecommerce website **162**. The video segments can include one or more of a testimonial, a demonstration, an offering description, or a case study involving the offering, among other options. The database can further relate video segments and offering descriptors, such that querying the database with an offering descriptor can return one or more video segments corresponding to the offering descriptor. Processor **112** can query the database with the set of offering descriptors to determine a subset of the plurality of stored video segments that correspond to the set of offering descriptors. The subset of video segments can then be used with subsequent steps of method **600**.

(105) In step **608**, a custom video is created from the subset of video segments. Processor **112** can create the custom video by sequencing the subset of video segments. The custom video does not include video segments that do not belong to the subset of video segments. The video segments can be ordered based on likely customer interest, overall relevance to the customer, relatedness to other video segments, or another suitable factor. The custom video can be stored as a file containing the custom video or as a file containing information, pointers, and/or links to the video segments of the custom video, as well as information pertaining the order in which the video segments should be played.

(106) In some examples, the length of the custom video can be limited to be less than a maximum video length. The maximum video length can be selected based on, for example, a maximum time that a customer is likely to watch a video or another suitable customer attribute. In these examples, the subset of video segments selected in step **606** can also be selected based on the length of each video segment, such that the overall length of all video segments in the subset of video segments does not exceed to maximum video length. Further, in some examples, video segments of the overall plurality of video segments may be relevant to more than one offering, and may be more relevant to some offerings than others. The database storing the overall plurality of video segments can include relevance information used to prioritize highly-relevant video segments in a custom video of limited length. Similarly, some video segments of the overall plurality of video segments may be of a much lower quality (e.g., in terms of bitrate, acting, etc.) than other video segments. The database storing the overall plurality of video segments can also include quality information that can be used to prioritize high-quality video segments in a custom video of limited length. Processor **112** can use an optimization algorithm to determine which video segments should be included in a custom video of limited length based on the length of each segment, the relevance of the segment, and/or the quality of the segment.

(107) In step **610**, a web page of ecommerce website **162** is modified by inserting the custom video into the web page. Processor **112** can automatically perform step **610** after step **608** is completed, such that the web page is automatically modified once the custom video has been created. Processor **112** can use one or more programs to of website modification module **160** to modify ecommerce website **162** and insert the custom video into a web page. The web page modified in step **610** can be a page for browsing offerings or can be a splash or landing page of ecommerce website **162**, among other options.

(108) In some examples, processor **112** can insert the custom video into the web page by inserting a file containing the custom video into the web page. In other examples, processor **112** can insert the custom video into the web page by inserting a link to a file containing the custom video or otherwise embedding the custom video in the web page. In yet further examples, processor **112** can insert the custom video into the web page by inserting pointers to each video segment of the custom video in the web page, as well as instructions that cause the segments to be played back-to-

back to appear as a continuous video and to be played in the correct order when viewed.

(109) Steps **602-608** of method **500** can be performed automatically and concurrently with the collection of electronic customer data used to create the customer profile. As such, the custom video can be created concurrently and in real-time or substantially real-time as the customer browses ecommerce website **162**. Step **610** of method **600** can be performed automatically once step **608** is completed, such that a customer browsing ecommerce website **162** can quickly or, in some examples, immediately be presented with an updated web page containing the custom video and the customer can watch the custom video during the same browsing session. Advantageously, this can improve a customer's browsing experience, potentially increasing the number of purchases made on ecommerce website **162** and increasing the likelihood that the customer will return to ecommerce website **162** to make subsequent or repeat purchases.

(110) Advantageously, method **600** allows for the automatic creation of a fully custom video that can be presented to a customer in an automatic manner on ecommerce website **162**. As compared to existing methods that simply insert a custom video into an otherwise pre-determined video sequence, method **600** provides a solution for creating custom promotion and advertising videos that are tailored to each customer, improving the overall effectiveness of the custom video at motivating customer purchases and further improving the customer's overall browsing experience on an ecommerce website.

(111) The systems and methods disclosed herein advantageously allow for a custom set of offerings and/or a custom video to be created concurrently with a customer's browsing of an ecommerce website. The ecommerce website can then be automatically updated and/or modified to present the custom set of offerings and/or the custom video to the customer shortly after and/or immediately after the customer interacts with the ecommerce website. For if the customer profile is created from customer answers to a questionnaire, the customer can be automatically directed to a web page including the custom video and/or the custom set of offerings immediately following the completion of the questionnaire. Presenting the custom set of offerings and/or the custom set of videos to the customer advantageously can improve the customer's overall browsing experience by allowing for seamless promotion and advertising via delivery of custom videos and further by allowing for the immediate and automatic creation of a tailored set of product recommendations specific to each customer interacting with the ecommerce website.

(112) While the invention has been described with reference to an exemplary embodiment(s), it will be understood by those skilled in the art that various changes may be made and equivalents may be substituted for elements thereof without departing from the scope of the invention. In addition, many modifications may be made to adapt a particular situation or material to the teachings of the invention without departing from the essential scope thereof. Therefore, it is intended that the invention not be limited to the particular embodiment(s) disclosed, but that the invention will include all embodiments falling within the scope of the present disclosure.

Claims

1. A method of creating custom video sequences, the method comprising: presenting an ecommerce website to a customer during a browsing session; automatically collecting, by a server system, electronic customer data from the ecommerce website, wherein: the electronic customer data describes at least one customer interaction with the ecommerce website; and the electronic customer data is automatically collected concurrently with the at least one customer interaction; concurrently with automatically collecting the electronic customer data: creating a customer profile of a customer based on the electronic customer data, wherein the customer profile comprises at least one customer descriptor; determining a set of offering descriptors based on the at least one customer descriptor using a descriptor taxonomy, wherein: the taxonomy of offering descriptors comprises a plurality of nodes arranged in a hierarchical taxonomy; each node of the plurality of

nodes is associated with an offering descriptor, such that the descriptor taxonomy organizes a plurality of offering descriptors, and wherein each offering descriptor describes aspects of one or more products or services offered for sale; and the at least one customer descriptor corresponds to at least one offering descriptor of the plurality of offering descriptors; automatically selecting a subset of video segments from a plurality of video segments based on the set of offering descriptors, wherein selecting the subset of video segments comprises querying an electronic database storing the plurality of video segments and corresponding segment lengths and segment quality scores for each video segment, wherein the segment quality score is based on a corresponding bitrate of each video segment; and automatically sequencing the subset of video segments into a custom video by selecting a combination of video segments dependent upon the segment length and the segment quality score of each video segment and having a combined length less than a maximum video sequence length dependent upon an expected characteristic of the customer; and automatically modifying a web page of the ecommerce website during the same browsing session of the customer by inserting instructions in the web page that, when executed, cause the web page to display the custom video having the subset of video segments in a continuous sequence.

2. The method of claim 1, further comprising causing the ecommerce website to display a link to the web page of the ecommerce website.

3. The method of claim 1, wherein the electronic database relates offering descriptors and video segments.

4. The method of claim 3, wherein each offering descriptor of the set of offering descriptors corresponds to one video segment of the plurality of video segments.

5. The method of claim 1, wherein: the electronic customer data comprises at least one answer to a questionnaire; the questionnaire is displayed by a web page of the ecommerce website; the questionnaire is answerable through customer interaction with the ecommerce website; and each question of the plurality of questions corresponds to one offering descriptor of the plurality of offering descriptors.

6. The method of claim 5, wherein collecting the one or more interactions comprises: the electronic customer data further comprises browsing history; the browsing history describes browsing of one or more pages of the ecommerce website; wherein the at least one customer descriptor comprises a first customer descriptor and a second customer descriptor, and further comprising: determining the first customer descriptor based on the browsing history; and determining the second customer descriptor based on the answer to the questionnaire.

7. The method of claim 6, further comprising creating profiling criteria based on the descriptor taxonomy, wherein: each criterion of the profiling criteria corresponds to a hierarchical level of the descriptor taxonomy; and creating a customer profile of the customer based on the electronic customer data comprises analyzing the electronic customer data with the profiling criteria to create the at least one customer descriptor.

8. The method of claim 1, wherein the at least one customer descriptor comprises a first customer descriptor and a second customer descriptor, and wherein determining the set of offerings descriptors comprises: identifying a first node of the taxonomy of offering descriptors, wherein: the first node is associated with a first offering descriptor; the first offering descriptor corresponds to the first customer descriptor; and the first node is a parent node of one or more child nodes, the one or more child nodes defined by the hierarchical taxonomy of the descriptor taxonomy; identifying a second node of the taxonomy of offering descriptors, wherein: the second node is a child node of the first node in the hierarchical taxonomy of the descriptor taxonomy; the second node is associated with a second offering descriptor; and the second offering descriptor corresponds to the second customer descriptor; wherein the set of offering descriptors comprises the first offering descriptor and the second offering descriptor.

9. The method of claim 8, wherein identifying the second node of the taxonomy of offerings

comprises: comparing the second customer descriptor to offering descriptors of the plurality of offering descriptors associated with one or more child nodes of the first node, the one or more child nodes defined by the hierarchical taxonomy; and identifying the second node based on the results of the comparison.

10. A system for creating custom video sequences, the system comprising: a webserver; an ecommerce website hosted by the webserver; an application server in electronic communication with the webserver, the application server comprising: a processor; a memory encoded with a set of first instructions that, when executed, cause the processor to: present an ecommerce website to a customer during a browsing session; automatically collect electronic customer data from the ecommerce website, wherein: the electronic customer data describes at least one customer interaction with the ecommerce website; and the electronic customer data is automatically collected concurrently with the at least one customer interaction; concurrently with the automatic collection of the electronic customer data: create a customer profile of the customer based on the electronic customer data, wherein the customer profile comprises at least one customer descriptor; determine a set of offering descriptors based on the at least one customer descriptor using a descriptor taxonomy, wherein: the taxonomy of offering descriptors comprises a plurality of nodes arranged in a hierarchical taxonomy; each node of the plurality of nodes is associated with an offering descriptor, such that the descriptor taxonomy organizes a plurality of offering descriptors, and wherein each offering descriptor describes aspects of one or more products or services offered for sale; and the at least one customer descriptor corresponds to at least one offering descriptor of the plurality of offering descriptors; automatically select a subset of video segments of a plurality of video segments based on the set of offering descriptors, wherein the selection of the subset of video segments comprises querying an electronic database storing the plurality of video segments and corresponding segment lengths and segment quality scores for each video segment, wherein a segment quality score is based on a corresponding bitrate of each video segment; and automatically sequence the subset of video segments into a custom video by selecting a combination of video segments dependent upon the segment length and the segment quality score of each video segment and having a combined length less than a maximum video sequence length dependent upon an expected characteristic of the customer; and automatically modify a web page of the ecommerce website during the same browsing session of the customer by inserting second instructions in the web page that, when executed, cause the web page to display the custom video having the subset of video segments in a continuous sequence.

11. The system of claim 10, wherein the at least one customer descriptor comprises a first customer descriptor and a second customer descriptor, and wherein the first instructions that, when executed, cause the processor to determine a set of offering descriptors cause the processor to: identify a first node of the taxonomy of offering descriptors, wherein: the first node is associated with a first offering descriptor; the first offering descriptor corresponds to the first customer descriptor; and the first node is a parent node of one or more child nodes, the one or more child nodes defined by the hierarchical taxonomy of the descriptor taxonomy; identify a second node of the taxonomy of offering descriptors, wherein: the second node is a child node of the first node in the hierarchical taxonomy of the descriptor taxonomy; the second node is associated with a second offering descriptor; and the second offering descriptor corresponds to the second customer descriptor; and store the first offering descriptor and the second offering descriptor in the set of offering descriptors.

12. The system of claim 11, wherein the first instructions that, when executed, cause the processor to determine a set of offering descriptors cause the processor to identify all child nodes of the second node, wherein: the child nodes of the second node are associated with child offering descriptors; and the set of offerings comprises the child offering descriptors.

13. The system of claim 10, wherein the first instructions, when executed, further cause the processor to cause the web page to automatically play the custom video.

